Chengyu Huang

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EDUCATION

Cornell University Aug 2024 - Present
- PhD in Computer Science
- GPA: 4.00/4.0; Research Area: Natural Language Processing; Advisor: Claire Cardie

Cornell University Aug 2024 - Aug 2026
- M.S. in Computer Science
- GPA: 4.00/4.0

National University of Singapore Aug 2019 - May 2023
- Bachelor of Computing; Major: Computer Science; Second Major: Mathematics
- Cumulative Average Point: 4.98/5.0; Rank: $\leq 2/759$; Most Outstanding Graduate

Swiss Federal Institute of Technology in Zurich Feb 2022 - July 2022
- Exchanged at ETH Zurich; Took ML, 3D Vision, NLP, Convex Optimization, and German

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Student Researcher, Google May 2025 - April 2026
- Worked on enhancing the robustness and effectiveness of preference optimization methods

Research Intern, H2Lab, University of Washington May 2023 – May 2024
- Investigated Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback for response generation with citations, a direction that aims at enhancing the truthfulness of language models

Research Assistant, School of Computing, NUS May 2023 – Aug 2024
- Designed and implemented an NLP based credential-taking intention and text brand detector for HTML webpages, which increases recall and precision of an existing phishing webpage detector

Research Intern, NExT++ Research Center, NUS Oct 2021 - May 2023
- Designed a global clustering model for conversation disentanglement with contrastive learning and K means, and the model was shown to be more effective than traditional 2-stage models

PUBLICATIONS

- Chengyu Huang, Zhuohang Li, Sheng-Yen Chou, and Claire Cardie. “Token-weighted Direct Preference Optimization with Attention”. *Proceedings of EMNLP, 2026*. [paper]
- Zhuohang Li, Xiaowei Li, Chengyu Huang, Guowang Li, Katayoon Goshvadi, Bo Dai, Dale Schuurmans, Paul Zhou, Hamid Palangi, Yiwen Song, Palash Goyal, Murat Kantarcioglu, Bradley A. Malin, and Yuan Xue. “Judging with Confidence: Calibrating Autoraters to Preference Distributions”. *Proceedings of EMNLP Findings, 2026*. [paper]
- Zhengxin Zhang*, Chengyu Huang*, Aochong Oliver Li, and Claire Cardie. “Better LLM Reasoning via Dual-Play”. *Proceedings of ACL Findings, 2026.* [paper]
- Chengyu Huang*, Zhengxin Zhang*, and Claire Cardie. “HAPO: Training Language Models to Reason Concisely via History-Aware Policy Optimization”. *Proceedings of AAAI, 2026.* [paper]
- Chengyu Huang and Tanya Goyal. “DCRM: A Heuristic to Measure Response Pair Quality in Preference Optimization”. *Proceedings of EMNLP Findings, 2025*. [paper]

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- Tri Cao*, Chengyu Huang*, Yuexin Li*, Huilin Wang, Amy He, Nay Oo, and Bryan Hooi. “PhishAgent: A robust Multimodal Agent for Phishing Webpage Detection”. *Proceedings of AAAI, 2025 (Oral)*. [paper]
- Chengyu Huang, Zeqiu Wu, Yushi Hu, and Wenya Wang. “Training Language Models to Generate Text with Citations via Fine-grained Rewards”. *Proceedings of ACL, 2024*. [paper]
- Yuexin Li, Chengyu Huang, Shumin Deng, Mei Lin Lock, Tri Cao, Nay Oo, Hoon Wei Lim, and Bryan Hooi. “KnowPhish: Large Language Models Meet Multimodal Knowledge Graphs for Enhancing Reference-Based Phishing Detection”. *USENIX Security, 2024*. [paper]
- Chengyu Huang, Zheng Zhang, Hao Fei, and Lizi Liao. “Conversation Disentanglement with Bi-Level Contrastive Learning”. *Proceedings of EMNLP Findings, 2022*. [paper]

PREPRINTS

- Chengyu Huang, Sheng-Yen Chou, Zhengxin Zhang, and Claire Cardie. “Bootstrapping Post-training Signals for Open-ended Tasks via Rubric-based Self-play on Pre-training Text”. *Preprint, 2026*. [paper]

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer EMNLP 2022, ARR 2024-2026, NeurIPS 2025-2026, AAAI 2025
Volunteer EMNLP 2023, ACL 2024

HONORS AND AWARDS

OpenAI Researcher Access Program Award 30 June 2026
Google Cloud Research Credits Award 15 June 2026
Sterling Prize Fellowship 29 Jan 2024
- A fellowship of $7000 from the PhD program in the CS department at Yale University (Declined)

IMDA Excellence in Computing Prize [certificate] 5 June 2023
- A cash prize of $3500 awarded to the Most Outstanding Graduate in the Bachelor of Computing programme from the Infocomm Media Development Authority in Singapore

Dean’s List, School of Computing, NUS Jan - May 2023; Jan - May 2021; Aug - Dec 2020
Senior Middle 2 Scholarship Aug 2018 - May 2023

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, CIS, Cornell University
- CS 5740: Natural Language Processing Jan 2026 - May 2026
- CS 4701: Practicum in Artificial Intelligence Aug 2025 - Dec 2025
- CS 3780: Introduction to Machine Learning Jan 2025 - May 2025

Teaching Assistant, School of Computing, NUS
- CS3230: Design and Analysis of Algorithms Aug 2021 - Nov 2021
- CS2100: Computer Organization Jan 2021 - Apr 2021
- CS1231S: Discrete Structures Aug 2020 - Nov 2020
- CS1101S: Programming Methodology Aug 2020 - Nov 2020

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Contributor and Mentor, RepoSense [repository] Jan 2021 - May 2023

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- Added new features such as highlighting and binary format support with Vue.js, Pug, and css, which enhanced the user interface of RepoSense, a contribution analysis tool of Git repositories
- Maintained the project, reviewed close to 100 pull requests, and made 5 product releases, which ensured it runs smoothly with 10 active developers and more than 1000 active users

Backend Engineer Intern, Global Payment, ByteDance May 2021 - Aug 2021

- Constructed an internal bot that monitors the transaction metrics from a TSDB and sends alerts to the engineers, alleviating the on-call team's burden and accelerating the error handling process

Developer Intern, Mobile Application**,** U Wave May 2020 - Aug 2020

- Developed user interfaces for services such as module calendar and bus timing of U Wave with Flutter and Dart, which became new functionalities of the mobile application

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Skills**: Java, Python, C programming, PostgreSQL, Go, html, and css
- **Languages:** Chinese and English: Proficient; German: A1.2